

Light

Light is a form of energy that our eyes can detect. It comes in all the colours of the rainbow, but when the colours are mixed together, light is white.



Fireflies

Some animals create their own light. Fireflies have tails that flash a yellowish-green colour at night to attract mates.

Where does light come from?

Light comes from inside atoms. When an atom needs to lose energy, it spits out the energy as a particle of light.

The light of a flame is caused by a chemical reaction that releases energy stored in the burning wax.



Casting shadows

Light can only travel in straight lines. If something blocks its path, it casts a shadow – a dark area that the light cannot reach.



Using light

We can use light for many different things.



CDs and DVDs store digital information that can be read by laser beam.



Cameras capture light in a split second to create photographs.



Telescopes magnify the light from distant stars and planets so we can see them.



Mirrors reflect light so we can see images of ourselves.



Periscopes bend light so we can see around corners.



Torches shine a beam of light to help us see in the dark.